

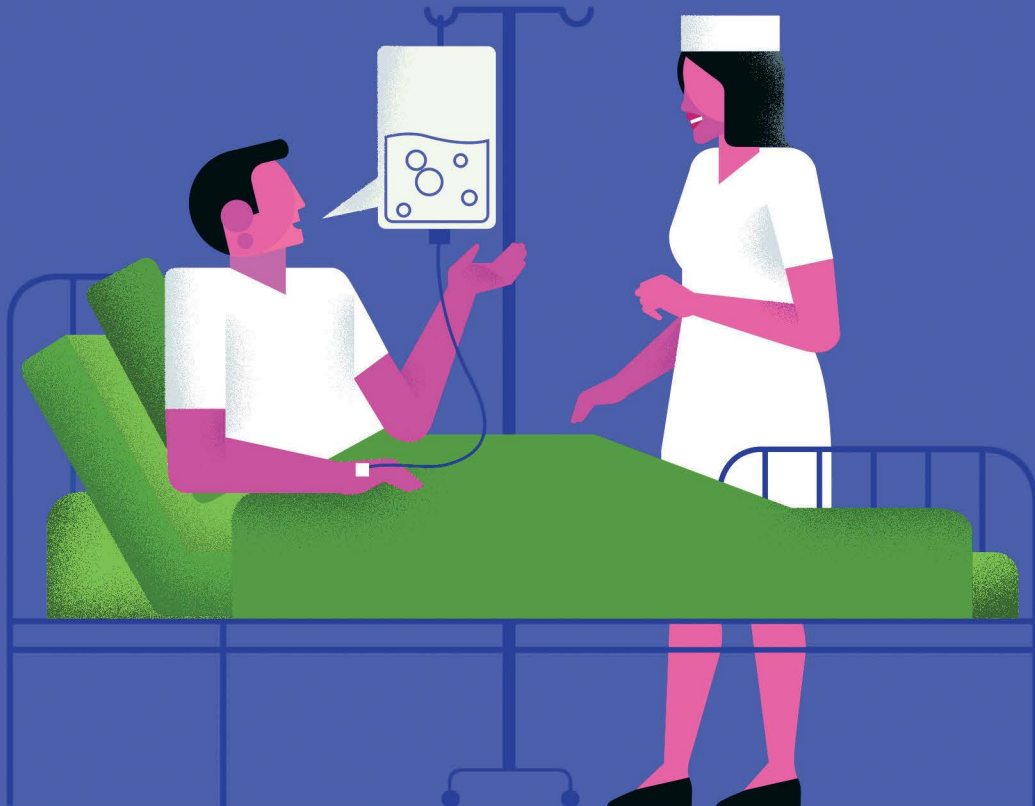


ILLUSTRATION BY RAJ VERMA

and life expectancy increases, the demand for trained doctors, nurses and allied health professionals will continue to rise.

Since no amount of infrastructure or technology can compensate for shortages of skilled healthcare professionals, to ensure our country's long-term future, we must invest not only in medical colleges but also in nursing education, paramedical training, and research.

Our country has undoubtedly made extraordinary progress in healthcare over the past few decades, but important challenges remain. Large disparities still exist between urban and rural healthcare, preventive healthcare requires much great-

er attention, and non-communicable diseases are placing unprecedented pressure on our healthcare system.

Public institutions remain indispensable, particularly for primary healthcare and rural outreach. At the same time, private entities have demonstrated their ability to rapidly build advanced infrastructure, introduce new technologies, drive clinical innovation and expand specialised care.

In addition, initiatives by the Government of India such as the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY) make medical treatment more accessible and affordable.

I believe both India and the

US have very different healthcare systems, each with its own strengths and challenges. But the way forward should be for both countries to learn from each other to ensure timely and high-quality care that reaches every person when they need it most.

The future of healthcare will not be shaped by one country's model replacing the other. Rather, it will be defined by the ability to learn from each other—combining the strengths of Western healthcare systems with India's agility, innovation and patient-centric approach to build more resilient, accessible and equitable healthcare for the world. **BT**

Views are personal